

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 4, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 55

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 45271.23 ▼ 24.58 0.05% NASDAQ 21497.73 ▲ 1.0% STOXX 600 546.78 ▲ 0.7% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 17/32, yield 4.211% OIL \$63.97 ▼ \$1.62 GOLD \$3,593.20 ▲ \$43.80 EURO \$1.1662 YEN 148.11

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Amazon.com suspended** a plan to redistribute its fleet of delivery vans after encountering resistance from owners of the third-party delivery companies that operate them. **B1**

◆ **The CFO of Elon Musk's** xAI left the company after a few months on the job, the latest in a string of high-profile departures. **B1**

◆ **Leading tech stocks** helped lift the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.5% and 1%, respectively, while the Dow industrials fell less than 0.1%. **B11**

◆ **Right-leaning cable news** channel Newsmax accused bigger rival Fox News of anticompetitive behavior in an antitrust lawsuit. **B4**

◆ **Shares of American** Bitcoin, a bitcoin mining and accumulation business backed by Donald Trump Jr. and Eric Trump, surged on their first day of trading. **B12**

◆ **Conoco said it would** cut up to a quarter of its workforce, or about 3,250 employees, adding to layoffs announced by major oil companies. **B3**

◆ **Campbell's reported** a decline in fiscal fourth-quarter organic sales and said it expects 2026 earnings to fall. **B2**

◆ **Dollar Tree warned** that tariff-related costs would pressure earnings in the current quarter even after sales jumped in the second. **B3**

◆ **Unilever said it is** evaluating its top 200 leaders and plans on "refreshing" about 25% amid a shake-up under its new chief executive. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **The federal government** improperly cut off \$2.2 billion in research funding from Harvard University and must restore the funds, a federal judge ruled, concluding the Trump administration's actions violated Harvard's constitutional rights. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** asked the Supreme Court to quickly hear its appeal of a ruling that rejected the president's sweeping global tariffs, saying the lower court loss was hurting the U.S. in trade negotiations. **A3**

◆ **Florida proposed** to eliminate all vaccine mandates, including for schoolchildren, which would make it the first state to end immunization requirements. **A1**

◆ **A federal appeals court** in a 2-1 ruling blocked Trump from using the centuries-old Alien Enemies Act to quickly deport a group of Venezuelan migrants. **A3**

◆ **Trump said that** New Orleans might be the next city to which he would deploy the National Guard after he sent troops to Los Angeles and Washington, D.C. **A3**

◆ **Trump deprecated** efforts to make public more details about Jeffrey Epstein just as some of the disgraced financier's victims visited Capitol Hill to tell their stories and implored the president and Congress to release more records. **A4**

◆ **More Americans** are testing positive for fentanyl use in workplace drug tests, highlighting a persistent challenge for employers. **A3**

JOURNAL REPORT

Artificial Intelligence: The best ways to use AI. **R1-B**

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China Hosts U.S. Adversaries at a Show of Might



MILITARY MUSCLE: Aerial drones were among the advanced weapons displayed by China on Wednesday in a Beijing parade that marked the country's victory in World War II. Leaders from Russia, North Korea and Iran joined Xi Jinping as spectators. **A7**

Google Ruling Shows Limits Of U.S. Antitrust Enforcement

Judges wary about crafting rules as legal system strains to keep up with market

By DAVE MICHAELS AND KATHERINE BLUNT

U.S. antitrust enforcers have spent years strategizing how to bring lawsuits against the nation's biggest technology companies, with the goal of restraining their power and promoting competition.

Tuesday's ruling imposing light penalties against Alphabet's Google highlights fundamental challenges with that approach, even when a judge finds a company has engaged in illegal monopolization.

U.S. District Judge Amit Mehta issued a landmark ruling last year that Google illegally maintained its search monopoly by entering distribution deals that boxed out competitors. The decision raised hopes among the company's competitors and critics that the judge would check its

power by breaking it up or requiring widespread changes to how it operates. But after a second-phase trial on remedies this year, Mehta ruled on Tuesday he wouldn't force sweeping changes at Google because the market had changed significantly since the Justice Department sued in 2020, and even since his ruling last year.

The judge, an appointee of President Barack Obama, ordered Google to share some of its search data and barred the company from striking deals

that exclude Google's search-engine competitors on devices and browsers. But he rejected a host of more stringent proposals offered by the Justice Department, including a forced spinoff of the Chrome browser, siding with Google's argument that a light touch was the better approach.

The decision was seen as a best-case outcome for Google, as well as Apple, which had billed

◆ **Heard on the Street: Google** win is Apple's too..... **B12**

Russian Drones Hit Civilians Near Front

By IAN LOVETT AND NIKITA NIKOLAIENKO

ORIKHIV, Ukraine—Anatoliy Suliz long ago grew accustomed to the sound of artillery in this front-line city. But in April, as he biked up a hill in search of cell signal, he heard buzzing overhead. He dived off the bike just as a drone smashed into the pavement next to him, bursting his eardrum and leaving a trail of gashes in his right side.

"Before it was dangerous if you were static," he said, noting that artillery usually hits build-

ings. "Now, it's dangerous to be moving, because drones hit moving targets."

Three-and-a-half years into the war, the conflict is deadlier for civilians, with explosive drones reshaping life in front-line towns and villages just as they have on the battlefield.

Some 1,674 civilians were killed or injured in July, the highest total of any month in more than three years, according to

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◆ **AI-powered drone swarms** enter the battlefield..... **A16**

How a Five-Toed Running Shoe Became Cool—to Fashion People

‘What is that?!’ Vibram FiveFingers is latest freaky footwear to be rebranded as chic.

By ISABEL SLONE

When Nicolaia Rips was in middle school, she remembers the “dorkiest kid” wearing Vibram FiveFingers, utilitarian running shoes with articulated toes meant to simulate the feeling of being barefoot. Still, the fashion writer couldn't help but buy a pair after seeing them pop up on her Instagram feed.

"I remember thinking, 'Oh the coolest girl I know is wearing Vibrams,'" Rips says.

Once a laughingstock, Vibram FiveFingers have become an unlikely favorite among the fashion set.

Model Paloma Elsesser, rapper DoeChii and influencer Leandra Medine Cohen have all been spotted in the amphibious, glove-like shoes. Stylish people from Copenhagen to New York are pairing them with diamond toe rings and

long skirts from the Row, and customizing them with ribbons and gems.

Rips now wears her FiveFingers with everything from sweatpants to two-piece cocktail sets.

"They can spark even the dullest of outfits," says Rips. She affectionately refers to the shoes as her "vibes."

Released in 2006, FiveFingers was initially marketed to yacht racers as a functional shoe that allows feet to maintain dexterity while offering enhanced grip. When barefoot running exploded after Christopher McDougall's 2009 book "Born to Run," the shoes spiked in popularity. In 2014, the company agreed to pay \$3.75 million to settle a class-action lawsuit alleging it had overstated the shoes' health benefits, including that it could strengthen muscles and

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Macy's Eyes A Turnaround

Macy's stock soared on an upturn in quarterly sales. **B1**

Macy's share price, year to date



Florida Takes Aim At Vaccine Mandates

By ALYSSA LUKPAT AND JOSEPH DE AVILA

Florida is proposing to eliminate all vaccine mandates, including for schoolchildren, which would make it the first state in the U.S. to end immunization requirements.

Vaccine mandates have eliminated the threat of many infectious diseases, and medical experts said removing the requirements undermines public safety. But antivaccine activists have been emboldened to challenge immunization

rules, especially since President Trump's appointment of vaccine skeptic Robert F. Kennedy Jr. as the U.S. Health and Human Services secretary.

Florida Surgeon General Joseph Ladapo, whom GOP Gov. Ron DeSantis appointed in 2021, said he is directing the state's Department of Health to eliminate all vaccine directives issued by the agency.

"Every last one of them is

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◆ **Covid-vaccine rules and** availability change..... **A9**

Influencers Mount TikTok War Against Mormon Church

Facing a 21st-century reckoning, the church aims to counter the narrative

By GEORGIA WELLS

When Madeline Woodward discovered ex-Mormon influencers on social media, it was her first glimpse of people finding joy after leaving the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

Woodward, a descendant of church pioneers, had struggled for years to reconcile her faith with church policies she viewed as antigay, discriminatory and troubling, like the polygamy of Mormon founder Joseph Smith.

After watching posts on TikTok and Instagram known as #exmo content, she realized she wasn't alone. In April, she re-

quested that her records be removed from church member rolls. Woodward, whose intense dedication to her faith previously led classmates to call her "Mormon Maddie," had officially severed ties with the church.

Once among the world's fastest-growing religions, Mormonism is facing a 21st-century reckoning, driven by social-media influencers—and the church is racing to counter them.

In video after video, an army of #exmo creators emphasize controversial aspects of LDS history, such as "death oaths" to protect temple secrets or a regulatory fine the church paid in

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL

Job hopping is out, job hugging is in for fearful workers. **A9**



SPORTS

The Steelers set their playbook on fire—and go all-in for a Super Bowl. **A12**